



SHAMIR BANERJEE

FMS, DELHI

If at all the Faculty of Management Studies (FMS), Delhi University falters in comparison to swash-buckling B-schools, it is in the matter of overseas placements. But if dean J.K. Mitra is to be believed, it will not be long before this gap is also filled. This year, average domestic salaries offered to students went up by nearly 40 per cent to Rs 10.55 lakh, whereas the average international offer was \$222,000 (Rs 91 lakh).

FMS features prominently in the BT-AC Nielsen Best School survey as a brand of choice among all stakeholders. The brilliance of the brand escapes none. While providing one of

the cheapest MBA programmes in the country today, FMS brings incredible value for money and value enhancement to its students. Mitra says the specialised course in services offered by the institute is "refreshingly new", compared to the general MBA programmes offered by the other schools.

The modules in sectors like finance, IT, healthcare, tourism and transportation and public services enable students to acquire expertise. The institute also holds a compulsory paper on creativity that all students have to pass. When grooming leaders for tomorrow, their creative capabilities have to be honed.

XLRI, JAMSHEDPUR

The institute has given the country some of the best HR managers over the years. Xavier's Labour Relations Institute (XLRI), Jamshedpur, has managed to maintain its position as the most credible HR institute despite the 'constraints of connectivity.'

Director Casimir Raj points out that high-flying CEOs might refrain from camping at a place like Jamshedpur, but that doesn't stop XLRI from getting its share of industry exposure, thanks to its reputation. The soul of the institute, says Raj, is the effort that goes into the maintenance of standards of excellence, with values like transparency (students know exactly how they are being evaluated), informality with faculty (teachers are available on campus at all times) and integrity—both inside and outside the classroom. Students are encouraged to be sincere and frank.

Though there is a host of new courses flooding the market, this age-old institution, which claims that management education is not just about skill acquisition but also about inculcating the right attitudes with the help of theory, method and practice.

XLRI, on its part, is busy charting out a programme exclusively for training the students at the National HRD network, the apex body for HR professionals across the country.



AMIT KUMAR

IIFT, DELHI

The Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT) was set up in 1963 to train professionals in international business and boost exports. While the need to push exports might not be so urgent now, IIFT's relevance from an ever-changing international business environment.

The only institute that has access to data of privileged nature, it also plays a role in policy-making by assisting the Government in carrying out studies and surveys. This is one of the reasons why, not just the students, but the faculty, too, consider it a privilege to be a part of the institute, says

Director K.T. Chacko. Teams at the institute are asked to assess current policies on a regular basis. This provides an enviable opportunity for students and faculty to upgrade their skills.

The course curriculum is updated on a regularity with inputs from experts and major recruiters. The institute has a Centre for International Trade and Technology. Another new area that is being explored is that of small and medium enterprises in the context of international trade policy.

The institute places great emphasis on constant renewal and regeneration. "The moment an institute thinks it has arrived, it stops progressing," says Chacko.